and that our thoughts do not copy whatever objective reality may be, they also understand that subjectivity and its attachments is an illusory construct.

Guna (quality-particular, trope): one of the ***Vaisheshika*** basic categories of reality (***padartha***), these are permanent characteristics of enduring objects (***dravya***) and cannot stand alone. They are other than enduring substances and motions. They fall under real universals. Some are physical features: colours, tastes, smells, touch, sounds (each exclusively related to the appropriate sense organ); proximity, distance, gravity, liquidity, viscidity and dimension. Others are non-physical properties specific to embodied selves: cognitions, pleasures, pains, desires, antipathies, conscious efforts, spiritual merit and demerit, and dispositions of personality. All of those listed so far occur as properties specific to each individual substance but we also find number, severalty, conjunction and disjunction, which always apply to a plurality of distinct individual substances.

Gunas are unique particular occurrences (sometimes called 'tropes'). The red specific to my table is a different instance from the red specific to my tie, although the two shades may be identical. Redness is not a quality but the universal (***samanya***) common to all instances of red. Since a colour pervades the whole substance in which it inheres, seeing an object's colour implies seeing the entire object.

The ***Nyaya-Vaisheshikas*** infer the existence of the non-perceptible and in itself non-conscious soul on the grounds that cognitions, desires and effort are qualities and as such require a substrate to which they belong.

The ***Purva Mimamsakas*** treat *gunas* as universals, saying that they are eternal, unitary and present in